

Gigabyte G5 KE

A budget RTX 3060 gaming laptop offering

₹99,990

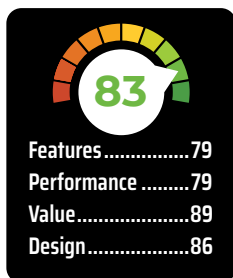
The latest G5 lineup from Gigabyte is certainly shaking things up, featuring the latest 12th-gen processors paired with RTX 30 series GPUs. So much so that maybe it's time you start considering Gigabyte if you're in the market for a decent budget gaming laptop. That being said, you're here for the "why" you should buy this laptop, so let's dive into the review of the Gigabyte G5 KE.

BUILD AND DESIGN

We quite liked the keyboard on the G5 KE; it features decent travel, spacing and the feedback is also nice. You also get a numpad, which is nice. The trackpad is not too large so it doesn't get in the way of your typing or gaming too much. Under the laptop, you've got the speaker cutouts near rubber bases that make the laptop fairly grippy. The G5 KE features a matte plastic body. The keys feature a smooth plastic finish, while the rest of the laptop features a slightly more textured finish. The laptop feels pretty sturdy despite its plastic build, and we didn't see too much flex on both the keyboard or the laptop display. Even the laptop display hinge was fairly sturdy. There's minimal flex when the laptop is shut as well. We didn't really have any complaints here. When it comes to I/O port offerings, we did feel like we were short one USB-A port, but we can't really complain considering everything else you're getting the G5 KE. Also, they probably ran out of real estate.

DISPLAY

The display on the Gigabyte G5 KE is not its strongest feature. It's not like the display is terrible. During our tests, we measured a peak brightness of 241 nits, which is plenty for when the laptop is



being indoors. However, you might have trouble outdoors. With an sRGB coverage of 61 per cent, you probably wouldn't want to use this laptop for colour accurate editing work either. However, for regular media

consumption and gaming this display should more than suffice.

PERFORMANCE

We start things off with the PCMark 10 synthetic benchmarks. The Intel Core i5-12500H is definitely pulling its weight in the G5 KE, even performing on par with previous gen i7s. The same can be seen with the R20 and R23 benchmarks, however, the processor does fall short when it comes to multithread performance. Coming to the RAM, as per our AIDA64 benchmarks, the DDR4-3200 RAM also performs as expected, even outperforming some other similar offerings. Finally, in the G5 KE's SSD, we saw read speeds north of 4500 MB/s which is the fastest we've tested this year. However, the write speeds were around 2200 MB/s which is comparatively slower, as per the CrystalDiskMark benchmark.

Now we get to gaming, which is powered by the NVIDIA RTX 3060. The RTX 3060 is an excellent entry point for a gaming laptop, allowing you to essentially handle all current AAA games at medium to high settings at FHD. It's

also fairly future-proof as far as gaming laptops are concerned.

In addition to synthetic gaming benchmarks via 3DMark, we also used in-game benchmarks from games. While the G5 KE fell short in the synthetic benchmarks, it scored identical in real-world gaming benchmarks, and in some cases, the highest in the price segment. Processor-intensive games like Valorant and Shadow of the Tomb Raider saw the largest difference in FPS, so Gigabyte is certainly doing something right.

HEAT AND NOISE

Once again, the Gigabyte G5 KE is in the middle of the pack when it comes to both heat and noise. It certainly can get loud and hot while under stress, but it's not the hottest or the loudest out there. It was definitely within expectations of a laptop that's running games, so we had no complaints. However, we did find that the laptop throttled the most of the lot in the segment. But, by a very small margin.

VERDICT

The G5 KE honestly has just about everything you might be looking for in a budget gaming laptop. We actually have no qualms about recommending this laptop as a solid entry point gaming laptop if you're looking for a 3060 option. Of course, there is also the G5 ME, a 3050Ti option if you're looking for an even cheaper alternative, however you'll also miss out on the Thunderbolt 4 port among other things.

—Manish Rajesh

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: 12th Gen Intel Core i5-12500H | GPU: NVIDIA GeForce RTX 3060 Laptop GPU 6GB GDDR6 | Display: 15.6-inch FHD 144Hz Display | RAM: 16GB DDR4-3200 | I/O: 1 x Type A USB 2.0 port, 1 x Type A USB 3.2 Gen 1 port | 1 x Type C USB 3.2 Gen 2 port, 1 x Thunderbolt 4 port | 1 x Mini DP 1.4, 1 x HDMI 2.1 | 1 x Combo Audio Jack, 1 x Microphone Jack | 1 x RJ-45 LAN port, 1 x MicroSD Card Reader | Bluetooth V5.2 | Battery: Lithium-Ion 54Wh | Dimensions: 36.0 (W) x 23.8 (D) x 2.39 (H) cm | Weight: 2kg

CONTACT

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